Harbor. Very shortly I started another picture costarring with Errol Flynn. It was called *Desperate Journey* and we played RAF pilots shot down behind the German lines.

My agent at the time was Lew Wasserman, now head of MCA Inc. He persuaded me to accept the studio's offer, pointing out that I was a reserve officer and soon could be called to active duty, so why not get the added money for whatever time was left? I have to confess I hadn't given a thought to possible active duty, probably because the army had designated me for "Limited Service" because of my poor eyesight.

Thank heaven for Lew. He was a great agent and friend and I was lucky to have him in both capacities. Three months after Pearl Harbor, I received a letter from the War Department. I didn't have to open it to know what it was. Written on the envelope in red ink were the words "Immediate Action," which meant active duty. I was ordered to report in fourteen days to Fort Mason, the port of embarkation in San Francisco.

There were more than fourteen days of filming left on *Desperate Journey*. A lot of rescheduling took place to get my final scenes on film. Long shots and shots of my back were saved for a double after I was gone.

On the morning of the fourteenth day, I reported to Colonel Philip T. Booker—thirty-four years, regular army, a graduate of the Virginia Military Institute. Along with some ROTC cadets from the University of Arizona, I was to serve as liaison officer loading convoys with troops bound for Australia. Our strategy was to build up a force there to prevent Japan from pinning down its flank on Australia and then being able to turn and attack the west coast of the United States.

When my turn came for a physical exam, everything was fine except my vision without glasses. One of the doctors who was administering the test told me after checking my